## FAMILY from 1A

Georgia Bureau of Investigation spokesman John Bankhead said Levi's family had wanted to come forward for several weeks: "We had to persuade them not to do this for a while."

More than anything else, Levi's mother said she "just can't understand why."

Although Parkman said she is in disbelief that someone who knew Levi would have taken his life, that is exactly what she believes may have happened.

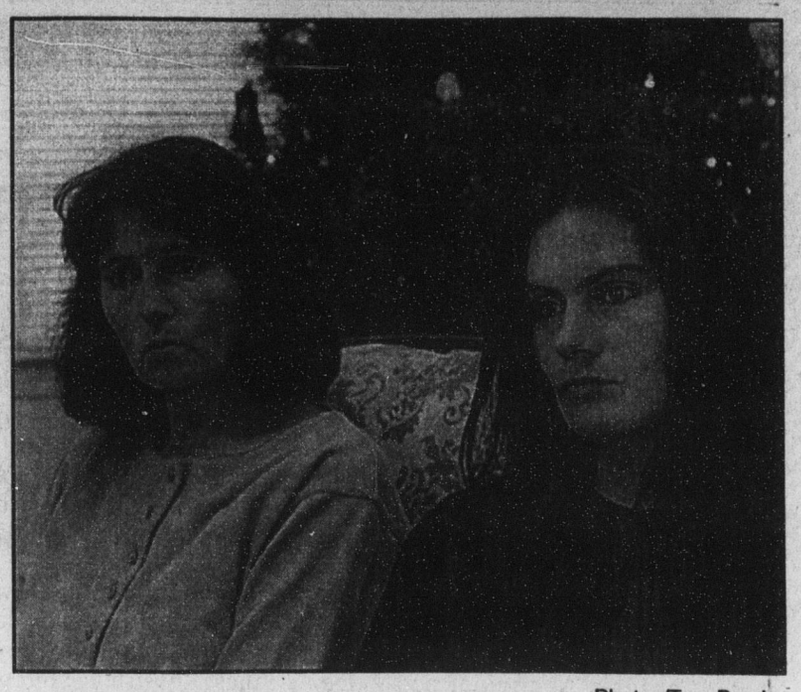
"I don't believe he would have got in a car with a stranger," she said, adding they had talked together about the importance of avoiding strangers "too many times."

To the person responsible for the family's tremendous loss, Hamby posed the question she hopes will someday be answered: "Why did you take him away from so many people who loved him? We need him so bad."

The other grandchildren want to talk about Levi, she said, and can't understand why he is gone: "We can't explain it to them because we don't know.

"If we could find out why," Hamby said the family could help them understand.

Both Hamby and Parkman said they believe someone has information which can help them answer their questions and put the person responsible for Levi's murder behind bars. "Please just call and let somebody know."



Photos/Tom Brooks

At Friday's family-called press conference, Janice Hamby, with her daughter, Marilyn Parkman, mother of Levi and Laci Frady.

# *He was only eleven, says poem penned by grandmother*

He was only eleven
So full of life and fun
Why do children have to pay
For things they've never done

He was only eleven
And had his whole future ahead
Birthday parties and school dances
But now he is dead

He was only eleven
He didn't seem to have a care
But now when I go to get him
I realize he's not there

He was only eleven
Are children easy prey?
They are so trusting
They believe what you say

He was only eleven
What did he have to give?
Not anything you wanted
Why didn't you let him live?

He was only eleven
And everyone has to die
We're happy he's in Heaven
But missing him makes us cry

# Investigators hoping to 'jog the memory'

By Beth L. Chester
Staff Writer

During a Friday afternoon press conference, agents investigating the murder of young Levi Frady echoed the slain 11-year-old's mother's belief that "someone must have seen or heard something" the evening Levi disappeared.

Marilyn Parkman ended the family's plea for help in bringing her son's killer to justice with the words, "Please call."

To help "jog the memory" of anyone who may have information in the case, Georgia Bureau of Investigation spokesperson John Bankhead wants to remind area residents of Oct. 22 – the day Levi went out for a ride on his bike.

"It was the night of the fifth game of the World Series," he said, "and it was a Wednesday night, when people may have been going to prayer service."

Perhaps most importantly, since Daylight Saving's Time was still in effect, Bankhead pointed out that investigators believe Levi came into contact with his assailant(s) before the sun went down – sometime between 6 and 7 p.m.

That's significant, he said, because it means someone "could have seen" the perpetrator on Little Mill Road before or after Levi was abducted. It's also possible, he said, that someone noticed "a young boy in a car" elsewhere that evening.

He's hoping the reminder will cause everyone to think back to that day, recall what he or she was doing and possibly remember even something seemingly insignificant which might help investigators solve the case.

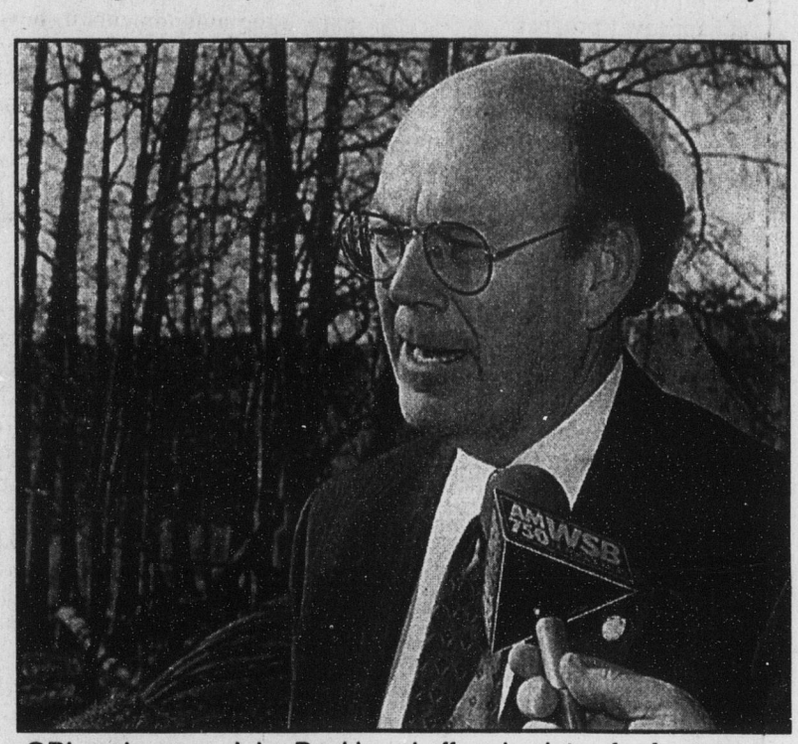
Bankhead told reporters that Levi's father, Milton Frady, who initially refused to come forward and answer questions about his son's disappearance, had now "pretty much been ruled out" as a suspect.

When asked whether others in the family continue to be possible suspects, Bankhead replied, "I don't feel that's a significant aspect."

As for the speculation that Levi was murdered as a means of retaliation against someone he was close to, the GBI spokesman would only say that agents "are not ruling out any possibility at this point."

Bankhead said investigators from several regional GBI offices are working to solve the case and have thus far compiled 30 volumes of case files and pursued more than 500 leads.

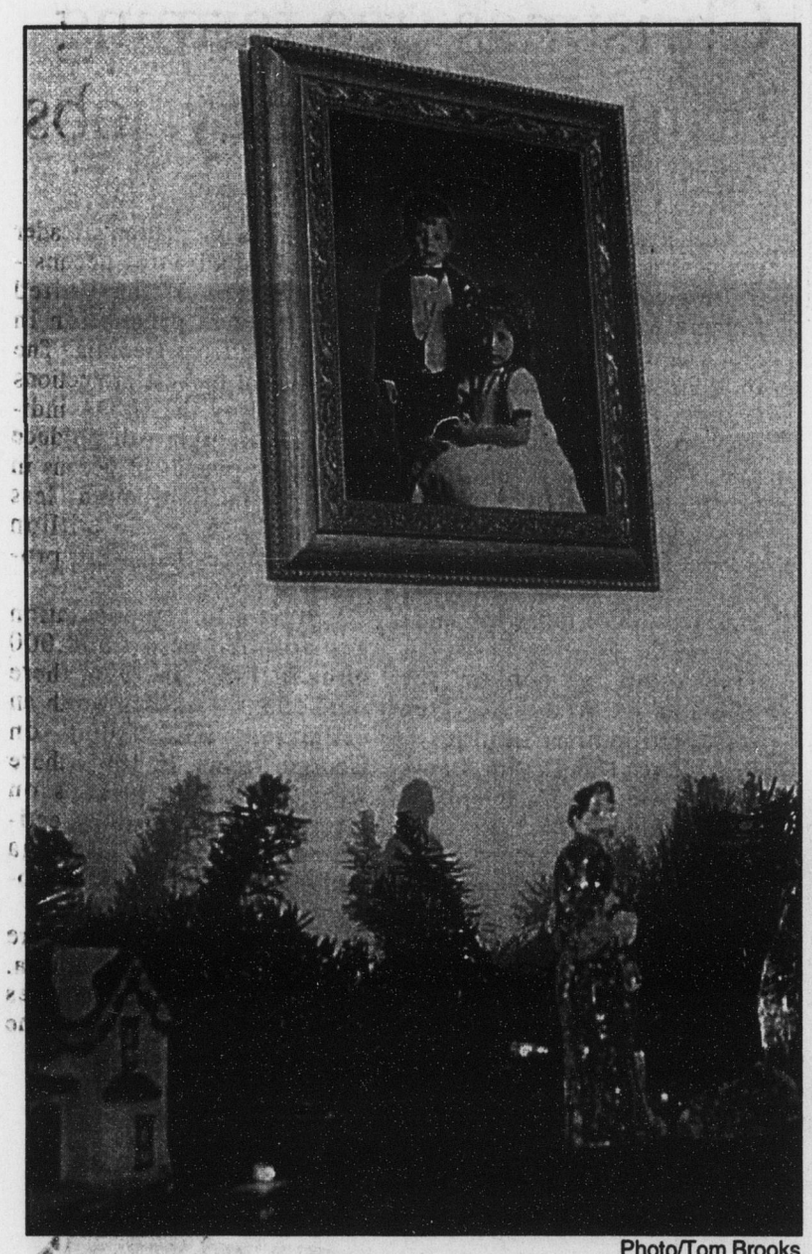
Special Agent-in-Charge of the Gainesville GBI region, Jim Hallman, said agents have polygraphed at least 20 individuals in the case to date. He would not reveal the identity of those questioned or say whether anyone failed the exam.




GBI spokesman John Bankhead offered points of reference.

Hallman and two other investigators returned last week from a lengthy consultation with behavioral scientists and other child abduction experts at the FBI training center Virginia.

Anyone with any information is asked to call the Dawson County hotline at 800-432-9284, the GBI at 535-5423 or Forsyth County Crime Stoppers at 888-7308. For those who prefer not to speak directly to law enforcement, write to: Levi Frady Case, P.O. Box 229, Dawsonville, Ga. 30534.



Photo/Tom Brooks

Portrait of the twins, at age 3, hangs as the room's focal point.





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